Delegate Manual

A Guide to Preparation and Participation

This Manual explains how to prepare for MoMUN and take part in committee proceedings as a delegate. It covers researching a country and agenda topic, developing proposals, working with other delegations, writing resolutions and participating in debate. Delegates should arrive ready to explain their country's position and contribute to the committee's work.

A delegate represents an assigned country or delegation within a committee. Their task is to understand the issue from that delegation's perspective, propose workable responses and negotiate with others. Preparation is important, but delegates should also listen during debate and assess how proposed changes affect their position.

The Student Officer Manual contains the detailed Rules of Procedure and resolution formatting requirements used by Chairs. This Delegate Manual introduces those procedures from the participant's perspective. Delegates assigned to the Security Council should also read the Security Council Manual, particularly its provisions on voting and the veto.

The MoMUN Code of Conduct applies throughout the conference. Delegates should read the official text separately for conduct, academic integrity, the use of electronic devices, attendance, safety and reporting concerns. The policies are not reproduced in this Manual. [1]

Table of Contents

PREPARING FOR THE CONFERENCE **4**

Understanding Your Assignment 4
Organising Your Preparation 4
Documents and Materials 4

AMBASSADORS **5**

The Role of an Ambassador 5
Coordination during the Conference 5
General Assembly Plenary Sessions 5

RESEARCH AND COUNTRY POLICY **6**

Researching the Issue 6
Identifying Your Country's Position 6
Developing Proposals 6

LOBBYING AND COOPERATION **7**

Forming an Alliance 7
Working on a Joint Resolution 7
Submitting the Draft 7

WRITING A RESOLUTION **8**

Structure and Header 8
Preambulatory Clauses 8
Operative Clauses 8
Formatting and Review 8

PARTICIPATING IN DEBATE **9**

Roll Call and Recognition 9
Open and Closed Debate 9
Delivering a Speech 9
Points of Information 9
Yielding the Floor 9

POINTS AND MOTIONS **10**

Raising a Point 10
Using a Motion 10
Right of Reply 10

AMENDING A RESOLUTION **11**

Preparing an Amendment 11
Introducing and Debating an Amendment 11
Second Degree Amendments and Corrections 11

VOTING AND FOLLOWING THE OUTCOME **12**

Before the Vote 12
Casting Your Vote 12
Security Council Delegates 12
After the Result 12
Notes and Communication 12

PRACTICAL CHECKLISTS **13**

Before the Conference 13
Before Submitting a Resolution 13
Before Taking the Floor 13
Before Submitting an Amendment 13
Before Voting 13
Final Remarks 13

FURTHER READING **14**

Preparing for the Conference

Understanding Your Assignment

Before beginning research, confirm your committee, assigned country or delegation, and agenda topics. Read the Study Guide for each topic and identify the main questions the committee is expected to address. If any part of the assignment is unclear, ask your MUN Advisor or the Chairs through the communication method provided by the conference.

The Study Guide is a starting point for research. Use its definitions, background and suggested sources to identify what you still need to understand. Note the committee's mandate, the parties involved, previous international action and the questions on which agreement may be difficult.

Check the conference schedule and any instructions issued for your committee. Do not assume that a position paper, opening speech or pre-written resolution is compulsory unless the conference has requested it. Where a document is required, follow the announced format and deadline.

Organising Your Preparation

Keep a clear record of the main facts, your delegation's position, relevant sources and possible proposals. Separate information about the issue from your interpretation of what your country would support. This makes it easier to explain your position and revise a proposal during negotiation.

Prepare a short summary for each topic covering the problem, your country's interests, previous action and the measures you would recommend. Identify which parts of a proposal are essential to your position and which details could be negotiated. Prepare questions that would help you assess other delegations' proposals.

Practise explaining your position aloud without reading an entire research document. You should be able to describe the problem, support your argument with evidence and explain what you want the committee to do. Keep additional detail available for Points of Information and drafting discussions.

Documents and Materials

Have access to your research notes, the relevant manuals, the Study Guides and any documents requested by the conference. Bring writing materials and follow the organisers' instructions for accessing or submitting committee documents. Device permissions are set out in the Code of Conduct and any authorised conference instructions.

Use clear file names and identify the latest version of a draft. Before sharing wording with another delegation, check that the version contains the changes you intend to propose. Keep a record of amendments and decisions so that you do not continue working from an outdated text.

Ambassadors

The Role of an Ambassador

An ambassador is the lead delegate coordinating the representatives of a country across its committees. The role supports communication and preparation within the delegation while each delegate remains responsible for their own committee work. Ambassadors do not deliver an opening-ceremony speech at MoMUN.

Before proceedings, ambassadors should know which delegates represent their country, their committee assignments and how to contact them through the methods permitted by the conference. They should help the delegation share relevant research, understand its overall country position and keep track of announcements affecting the group.

Coordination during the Conference

Ambassadors should communicate relevant announcements and help their delegation prepare for the General Assembly plenary session. They may help delegates identify questions that need to be referred to the Chairs, MUN Advisor or organisers. The role does not give an ambassador authority to change another committee's procedure or speak for a delegate without the appropriate recognition.

Where an issue concerns a particular committee, the delegate should use the normal committee procedure. Ambassadors should coordinate their group without disrupting committee sessions or assuming permission to leave a room or use a device. The applicable rules remain those of the conference and Code of Conduct.

General Assembly Plenary Sessions

During General Assembly plenary sessions, the ambassador raises the country's placard on behalf of the entire delegation for Roll Call and voting. The ambassador should listen for the country's name, make its presence clear when called, and follow the presiding Chairs' instructions.

Before a plenary vote, the country's delegates should agree on their delegation's position. The ambassador then raises the placard for the appropriate voting option on behalf of the delegation, rather than having several delegates from the same country raise separate placards. If the item or voting instruction is unclear, clarification should be requested through the recognised procedure before voting begins.

An ambassador's coordinating role does not create extra votes or override the voting rights applicable to the delegation. When the ambassador is unavailable, the delegation should notify the presiding Chairs and obtain instructions for representation, rather than assume an unannounced substitute is automatically recognised.

Research and Country Policy

Researching the Issue

Start by understanding the problem before deciding on a solution. Identify its causes, the groups affected, existing responses and the obstacles to implementation. Check the meaning of terms that recur in the Study Guide or in relevant international documents.

Use sources that can be traced to their original publication. Official United Nations documents, government statements, reports from relevant organisations and reliable research can help establish the background. News reporting can provide context, but should be checked against the underlying statement, report or event where possible.

For each important fact, note the source, publication date and any relevant page or paragraph. Distinguish estimates from confirmed figures, and check the period and population to which a statistic refers. A figure about one country or year should not be presented as a finding about the entire issue.

When referring to an existing resolution, record the body that adopted it, its document symbol and the relevant provisions. Read the text you intend to rely on. A title or summary may not explain the scope, limitations or conditions of the action adopted.

Identifying Your Country's Position

Research your country's official statements, relevant votes, treaty commitments and involvement in the issue. Consider its geographic circumstances, economic interests, security concerns and relationships with other states. Your proposals should be consistent with this evidence.

A country may support the aim of a proposal while disagreeing with its methods. For example, a delegation may support stronger monitoring but oppose the creation of a new institution. Explain the specific reason for your position so that other delegates can discuss changes that might address it.

If no clear official position can be found, draw a cautious inference from relevant policy and interests. Keep that inference separate from a documented government statement. Do not invent a quotation, vote or commitment to make a position appear more certain.

Developing Proposals

A useful proposal identifies an action, the body or actors expected to implement it, and a practical means of assessing progress. Consider how it relates to existing work and whether the committee can recommend or decide upon that action. Check the mandate before proposing a new responsibility for an organisation.

Prepare more than one way of addressing an important concern. An alternative may change the scope, timeline, reporting arrangements or level of international involvement. This gives your delegation room to negotiate while remaining consistent with its position.

Lobbying and Cooperation

Forming an Alliance

Lobbying takes place at the beginning of the committee's work on a topic and consists mainly of informal discussion between delegates. Its purpose is to develop a joint resolution proposing responses to the agenda topic. Delegates should use this time to compare positions and identify compatible proposals.

Introduce your delegation and explain the measures you would like to pursue. Ask other delegates what their countries support and which concerns they need a resolution to address. An alliance should be based on compatible positions and interests, rather than personal familiarity alone.

If you are uncertain which group to join, ask the Chairs for guidance. Once you join a group, contribute to its discussion and drafting. Read the proposal as a whole so that you understand how your contribution relates to the other clauses.

Working on a Joint Resolution

Agree on the main purpose of the resolution before dividing the drafting work. Check that the clauses address the same problem coherently, use compatible terms and assign responsibilities consistently. Combining several documents without reviewing the result can create duplication or contradictory proposals.

Delegates should discuss substantive changes with the group and keep a shared understanding of the current wording. If a clause creates disagreement, identify the precise concern and consider whether a change in scope, timing or implementation would address it. Check the revised wording before agreeing to it.

Each resolution must identify a Main Submitter, who is responsible for presenting it and delivering the opening speech. The remaining supporting delegations are listed as co-submitters. The Main Submitter's country is not repeated in the co-submitter field.

Under the general MoMUN procedure, each delegation may co-submit one resolution per agenda topic. Check that your delegation is not listed on more than one resolution for the same topic, and ask the Chairs if an entry needs to be corrected. Read the final draft before confirming that your delegation is listed.

Submitting the Draft

Follow the submission method and deadlines announced by the Chairs. Allow time for corrections and Approval Panel review. If the Chairs request clarification, the submitters should explain the intended proposal and agree on wording that preserves its meaning while addressing the concern.

Only use the version cleared for introduction into debate. Further substantive changes should follow the appropriate correction or amendment procedure. Approval for debate allows the committee to consider a proposal; it does not mean that the committee has endorsed it.

Writing a Resolution

Structure and Header

A resolution consists of a header, preambulatory clauses and operative clauses. The header identifies the forum, agenda topic, Main Submitter and co-submitters. Use the committee's full name followed by its abbreviation, and write country names in full. List co-submitters alphabetically.

Header labels should be in bold. The wording should identify the topic accurately and distinguish the delegation introducing the resolution from the other submitters. Check the names against the committee's allocation list before submission.

Preambulatory Clauses

Preambulatory clauses explain the background and reasons for the proposed action. They may refer to relevant developments, previous international action or concerns that the operative clauses will address. They should establish the context rather than introduce instructions to be carried out.

The introductory phrase is italicised, each clause ends with a comma, and preambulatory clauses are not numbered. Examples of introductory phrases include "Recalling", "Recognising" and "Deeply concerned". Further examples appear in the Student Officer Manual.

Operative Clauses

Operative clauses state the actions, recommendations or decisions proposed. Choose an introductory phrase that reflects the action and the committee's mandate, such as "Encourages", "Requests" or "Calls upon". Underline the introductory phrase.

Number main clauses with Arabic numerals followed by a period, sub-clauses with lowercase letters followed by a closing bracket, and sub-sub-clauses with lowercase Roman numerals followed by a period. Each main clause ends with a semi-colon, except the final clause of the resolution, which ends with a full stop. Use a colon when introducing a list and the punctuation shown in the general Manual's examples for nested clauses.

Specify who should act and what the action should achieve. Where relevant, explain implementation, reporting and review. Avoid a clause that merely calls for "more cooperation" without identifying what cooperation is proposed or how it would address the issue.

Funding methods and possible resources may be discussed, but resolutions must not specify exact financial amounts under the general MoMUN rules. Check that proposals involving another body fall within its role and that the resolution does not assign powers the committee does not have.

Formatting and Review

Use Times New Roman, size 11, full justification and single line spacing. Set paragraph spacing to 0pt before and 8pt after. Page margins should be 1 inch at the top and bottom and 0.75 inches on the left and right. Leave a line space between main clauses.

Before submission, read the resolution from beginning to end. Check numbering, names, spelling, introductory phrases and punctuation. Confirm that references are accurate and that clauses do not repeat or contradict one another. Each submitter should be able to explain the proposals they support.

Participating in Debate

Roll Call and Recognition

Respond when the Chairs call your delegation during Roll Call. If your delegation has not been called, inform the Chairs when they ask whether any delegation has been omitted. If you need to leave or cannot attend a session, follow the attendance procedure and inform the Chairs.

When the floor is open, raise your placard if you wish to speak. Wait until the Chairs recognise your delegation before beginning. Follow the announced speaking time and address the item currently under consideration.

Open and Closed Debate

Open Debate is used for resolutions. Delegates may speak in favour of or against the resolution and discuss particular clauses. Listen to previous speakers so that your contribution responds to the discussion rather than simply repeating a prepared statement.

Closed Debate is used for amendments, with separate speeches in favour and against. If you request the floor during time in favour, your speech should support the amendment; during time against, it should explain objections to it. The amendment's submitter delivers the first speech in favour.

Delivering a Speech

A speech should make a clear contribution to the item being debated. Begin by stating your delegation's position, explain the reason for it, and identify the action or change you want the committee to consider. Use a small number of relevant facts rather than reading a long list of research findings.

A useful contribution may explain how a clause would work, identify a practical difficulty or propose wording that could secure wider support. Where you disagree, specify the provision and explain its effect. Prepare to answer questions about the mechanism you recommend.

For example: "The delegation supports the reporting mechanism, but clause 3 should identify who will prepare the report. The delegation therefore encourages an amendment clarifying that responsibility." This illustrates how to connect a position with a proposed change; it is not a required country position.

Points of Information

After your speech, the Chairs will ask whether you accept Points of Information (POIs). You may decline, accept any and all Points, or set a maximum. The Chairs manage recognition, time and your stated limit.

When asking a POI, state one clear question relevant to the speech or proposal, with brief context if needed. Wait for recognition, rise to ask, remain standing for the reply, then sit. Requests for clarification go through the Chairs; direct dialogue is not permitted.

You may request one follow-up immediately after an answer. It must relate to the original POI and requires the Chairs' recognition and the Speaker's agreement. A Speaker may also reply to a POI via a note.

Yielding the Floor

After your speech and POIs, yield to the Chairs or request to yield to another delegation. A yield to another delegate requires the Chairs' acceptance and that delegate's agreement.

Only one consecutive yield between delegates is allowed; the receiving delegate must then yield to the Chairs. In Closed Debate, a yield between delegates is possible only while time remains in the relevant segment. The final speaker yields to the Chairs.

Points and Motions

Raising a Point

Points allow delegates to ask questions or address procedural and personal matters. Wait for recognition before stating a Point. Points may not interrupt a speaker, except a Point of Personal Privilege concerning audibility. POIs to a Speaker are raised through the question procedure described above.

A Point of Parliamentary Inquiry asks about the Rules of Procedure. Use it if you are unsure which Motion is in order, how a stage of debate works or what the Chairs have just announced.

A Point of Order identifies a procedural error relating directly to what has just happened. State the specific concern and allow the Chairs to explain or correct the procedure. Disagreement with a proposal is addressed through debate, not through a Point of Order.

A Point of Information to the Chairs asks a question that does not fall under Parliamentary Inquiry or Order, such as clarification of the agenda. A Point of Personal Privilege concerns your wellbeing or a personal request. Where appropriate, the Chairs may invite you to discuss it privately.

Using a Motion

Motions request a procedural action and may be raised only when the floor is open, without interrupting a speaker. The Chairs apply the requirements in the Student Officer Manual. The principal Motions are summarised below.

A Motion to approach the Chairs requests a personal discussion. A Motion to adjourn debate requests a break. Both are subject to the Chairs' discretion.

A Motion to move to the previous question requests an end to the current stage of debate. During time in favour on an amendment, it moves to time against; otherwise it closes debate on the item and moves to voting. It requires a second and no objections, and the Chairs may overrule it.

A Motion to extend debate time requests more time for the segment currently in progress. It should be raised towards the end of that segment, requires a second and is subject to the Chairs' discretion. It does not reopen time that has already elapsed.

A Motion to follow-up requests a further question relating to a POI just answered. A Motion to extend Points of Information requests additional POIs before the Speaker has yielded. Additional questions require the Speaker's agreement and the Chairs' acceptance, and may not exceed a numerical limit already set by the Speaker.

A Motion to divide the House requests another vote without abstentions, immediately after votes have been counted. A Motion to retake the vote addresses a suspected error in voting or counting. A Motion to vote by roll call requests that each present delegation state its vote individually. All are subject to the Chairs' ruling.

A Motion to withdraw a resolution concerns the resolution currently under debate and follows the co-submitter requirements in the general Manual. A delegate should not assume that a proposal has been withdrawn until the Chairs confirm it.

Right of Reply

A delegate whose personal or national integrity has been impugned may request a Right of Reply. A short statement is allowed at the Chairs' discretion, without interrupting a speaker or accepting POIs. Policy disagreements should normally be addressed in debate.

Amending a Resolution

Preparing an Amendment

An amendment changes a resolution during debate. It may add a clause, strike a clause or replace wording within a clause. Each amendment must concern one clause; proposals affecting different clauses require separate amendments.

Identify your delegation, the target clause and any relevant sub-clause, the type of amendment and the exact change proposed. Use the submission method agreed by the committee and announced by the Chairs. A paper Amendment Sheet is not required where another method has been agreed.

For a replacement, identify the wording to be removed and provide the text to be inserted. For an addition, state where the new clause belongs and provide its complete wording. For a deletion, identify precisely which clause or part is to be removed. Your proposal should be clear enough to incorporate directly into the resolution.

For example, if clause 2 requests a report within thirty days, an amendment could replace “thirty days” with “sixty days”. Identify clause 2 and explain why the revised deadline would improve the proposal. This is a substantive change even though it replaces only two words.

Introducing and Debating an Amendment

The Chairs check whether an amendment is relevant, properly formatted, within the committee’s mandate and suitable for debate in the remaining time. Submission does not guarantee that it will be entertained. Continue to follow the current debate until the Chairs introduce your amendment.

If the amendment is entertained, the Chairs display it and move to Closed Debate. The submitter delivers the first speech in favour and may be asked to read the amendment aloud. Equal numbers of speeches are allocated in favour and against. Debate on amendments counts towards the resolution’s overall debate time.

At the end of debate, the committee votes on the amendment. If it passes, the displayed resolution is updated; if it fails, the wording remains unchanged. Passing an amendment does not adopt the resolution, which must still be considered and voted upon as a whole.

Second Degree Amendments and Corrections

A second-degree amendment proposes a change to an amendment already under discussion. It may be introduced during time against the first-degree amendment, if the Chairs entertain it. Debate on the second-degree amendment does not count as time against the first-degree amendment.

After the second-degree amendment is decided, debate on the first-degree amendment resumes, with any adopted changes incorporated. The first-degree amendment still requires its own vote. Amendments to the third degree or beyond are not in order.

Formatting or grammatical corrections that do not change substance are handled under the general Manual’s provisions. Delegates should bring an error to the Chairs’ attention. A change to the action, scope, obligation or intended effect of a clause should be submitted as a substantive amendment rather than treated as an automatic correction.

Voting and Following the Outcome

Before the Vote

Read the final wording of the item before voting, including all adopted amendments. Distinguish between a vote on an amendment and a vote on the resolution as a whole. If the wording or procedure is unclear, ask for clarification before the voting procedure begins.

Voting rights depend on your assigned delegation and committee. Under the general MoMUN procedure, the Holy See and Palestine, as Permanent Observers, do not vote on substantive items. Specialised committees may have additional arrangements, which the Chairs should explain.

During voting, note passing is suspended and entry to or exit from the committee room is restricted under the general procedure. No Points or Motions are in order except a Point of Personal Privilege. Motions concerning the vote may be raised after the votes have been counted.

Casting Your Vote

For ordinary substantive votes, eligible delegates may vote in favour, against or abstain. An item passes when the votes in favour exceed the votes against; abstentions are not included in that comparison. An equal number in favour and against means that the item does not pass.

For example, seven votes in favour, five against and three abstentions result in adoption under the general rule. Six in favour, six against and three abstentions do not. These examples apply to ordinary committees, not to the Security Council's special voting system.

Procedural votes do not permit abstentions under the general rules. Follow the Chairs' explanation of the question and cast one clear vote. If you believe you have voted twice or the count is incorrect, raise the appropriate Motion after the votes have been counted.

Security Council Delegates

Delegates assigned to the Security Council must use its separate Manual. Its nine-vote requirement and the permanent members' veto replace the ordinary substantive majority rule described above. Do not apply the ordinary committee examples to a Council resolution or amendment.

After the Result

Listen to the totals and outcome announced by the Chairs. An adopted amendment becomes part of the working resolution, while an adopted resolution concludes the committee's decision on that text. Follow the Chairs' instructions for the next item or stage of proceedings.

If an item is not adopted, identify which concerns prevented agreement. Any further negotiation, revised submission or reintroduction must follow the Chairs' directions and the normal approval procedure. A failed vote does not automatically reopen the same item.

Notes and Communication

During formal debate, notes may be exchanged in accordance with the general Manual. They should be in English and relevant to the debate, and may be read by the Chairs or Administrative Staff. Cross-committee note passing is not permitted. The Chairs may suspend note passing if it disrupts proceedings.

Practical Checklists

Before the Conference

Confirm your assignment and read the Study Guides, relevant manuals and Code of Conduct. Research your country and the agenda topics, record your sources and identify the proposals you can support. Complete any documents specifically requested by the conference.

Practise a short speech, prepare questions about implementation and anticipate objections to your proposals. Organise your notes so that you can find evidence quickly during discussion.

Before Submitting a Resolution

Confirm the Main Submitter and co-submitters, check that your delegation is listed on only one resolution for the topic, and read the whole draft. Check the mandate, implementation, consistency, formatting and punctuation. Submit the version agreed by the group through the announced method.

Before Taking the Floor

Identify the item and stage of debate. Decide what your speech will add, which evidence supports it and what action you want delegates to consider. Follow the Chairs' time limit, then state whether you will accept POIs and yield the floor as directed.

Before Submitting an Amendment

Identify one target clause, specify the type of change and provide exact wording. Check that it reflects your country's position and improves the proposal. Be ready to explain the change in the first speech in favour if it is entertained.

Before Voting

Check the final text, your delegation's eligibility and the voting rule for your committee. Cast one clear vote and listen to the result. Ask about uncertainties before voting begins rather than after an outcome you did not expect.

Final Remarks

Effective participation combines preparation with attention to the discussion taking place. A delegate contributes by developing workable proposals, explaining concerns, asking useful questions and helping the committee reach an informed decision. If you are uncertain about a procedure, ask the Chairs through the appropriate Point.

Further Reading

MoMUN Student Officer Manual. Consult the sections on Rules of Procedure, resolution formatting and correction, and the appendices containing introductory phrases and an example resolution.

MoMUN Security Council Manual. Required supplementary reading for delegates assigned to the Security Council, particularly its sections on membership, debate, amendments and voting.

[1] MoMUN Code of Conduct. Read the official Code of Conduct

The committee's Study Guides, allocation list and instructions issued by the Secretariat provide the topic-specific and practical information needed for each conference assignment.